mv-3

One Skill.
One reply per decision.

our final submission, Cut 3

- **Q1** How we designed it
- **Q2** What the logs taught us
- **Q3** Why no scripts
- **Q4** How robust it is
- **Q5** What Skills can and can't do

48 months of career. Three ways to lose.



month 1 · 3 stories a month, effects hidden ■ review every 6 months month 48

Never promoted

dismissed

Hidden risk

two blow-ups: trust crisis. The only hint is the HR remark's tone

Burnout

or running out of money

Every decision asks three questions

1 What does this option change?

2 What does the career need now?

3 Which rule applies right now?

#1 is the hard one ↓

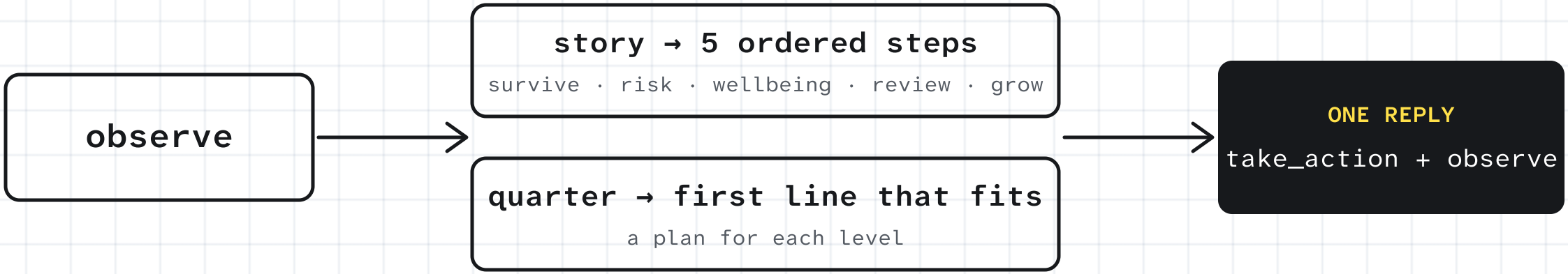
83%

of risky options spotted by DeepSeek

45–49%

of options that raise Skill or Output

One loop, one reply per decision



Review in N | Now S.. N.. O.. | Best S.. N.. O.. | Reviews here: 0

↑ every note starts like this: memory + switch

One Skill. The manifest repeats what matters.

SKILL.md

turn loop · status line · story steps · quarterly plan · near-limit table

+

manifest.json

the essentials again, because the agent reads the Skill once, early

With several Skills, the agent opened one and missed the rules in another.

Three cuts, three versions

Cut 1 · 27 Oct

t13-read-v4

64.75

official · 13th of 34

Cut 2 · 30 Oct

mv-5r

45.44

official

Cut 3 · 1 Nov

mv-3

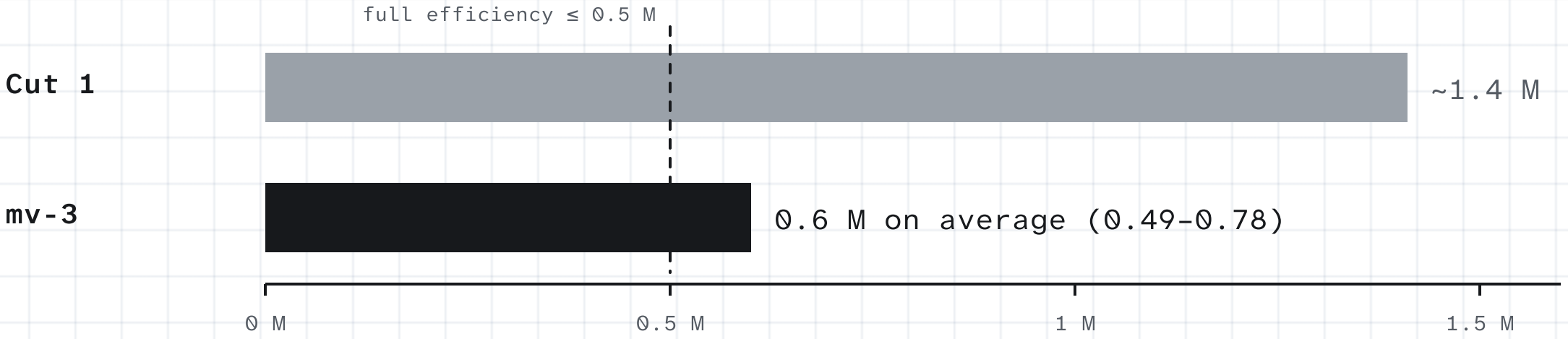
?

not known yet

What we saw → what we wrote

Promotions lost by one point, in the last story before a review	→	**Protect Network and Output in the two months before a review**
“Responsible” private or phased fixes hid risk	→	**Drop options that may bury a problem**
The agent thought a polite “no” keeps Network	→	**Network falls when someone is let down, even politely**

Every call resends everything. So: fewer replies.

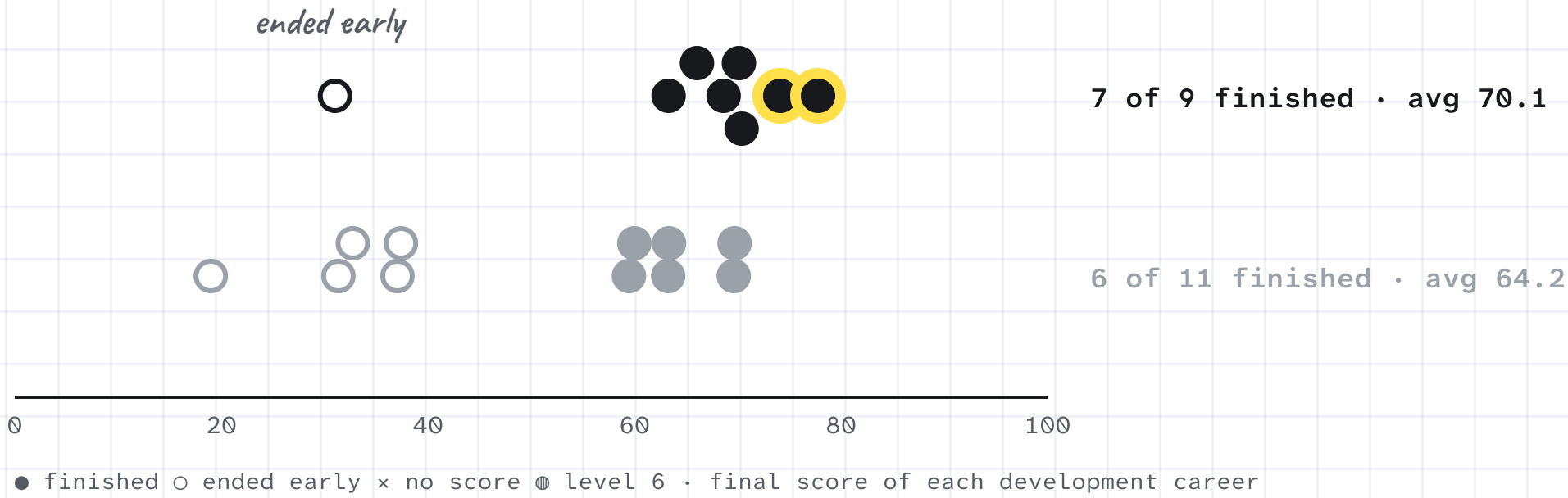



```
tool_calls: [take_action(…), observe(…)]
```

only worked once we showed this exact shape

One extra sentence. Worse careers.

mv-4 = mv-3 + “Never end a reply with text only … not in prose.”



Cheap tests fooled us. Full careers didn't.

	CHEAP TEST SAID	FULL CAREERS SAID
Cut 2	✓ safer at later levels	✗ 2 of 3 collapsed early
Cut 1 rebuilt	✓ leaves the start 79% vs 73%	✗ 3 of 5 dismissed
Play bolder	✓ climb faster	✗ no higher, blow-ups

→ *so we sent the Skill of our best full careers*

No scripts. No reference files. On purpose.

Tried one

Best career at the sixth level, but 3 of 7 ended early and ~1.6× the tokens

Wrong problem

What fails is reading the options. A script can't read them better than the model

Never reopened

The agent reads the Skill early and doesn't open extra files

It only uses what the agent can see

HR remark tone

review talks

quarterly menu effects

its own notes

a review every 6 months

No event names, no fixed answers, no hidden thresholds. Same procedure if the wording changes.

HONEST LIMITS

~1 career in 4 still collapses, mostly at the start · assumes the 6-month calendar · some providers type the tool call as text

Skills change how an agent works, not what it sees

Good at

— format: tokens per month cut to less than half on average

— concrete quarterly orders

Bad at

— seeing which option costs Output

— staying in scope: 1 in 5 unrelated choices changed

— one sentence can change the game

Priorities and discipline. Not understanding.

The Skill of our best full careers

70.1

average of 7 complete careers out of 9 · two reached level 6

<½

the tokens per month of our first cut

0

event names or hidden thresholds

Thanks! — Gradient Depression

development careers, not official scores, except 64.75 and 45.44